

POOOL Approved Marketing Materials Policy

Phase 1 – Controlled Referral Program

Effective Date: [DATE]

Applies To: All applicants, approved affiliates, pilot affiliates, reactivated affiliates, internal reviewers, content owners, compliance personnel, marketing personnel, support personnel, and any persons creating, reviewing, approving, distributing, or using affiliate-facing promotional materials.

1. Purpose

This Approved Marketing Materials Policy (“**Policy**”) governs the creation, approval, distribution, use, modification, localization, replacement, withdrawal, review, and enforcement of marketing materials used in connection with the POOOL Affiliate Program (the “**Program**”).

Its purpose is to ensure that affiliate-related content:

- remains within the Phase 1 referral-only model,
- stays consistent with official POOOL information,
- does not drift into advisory or sales conduct,
- supports required disclosure logic,
- can be versioned, tracked, and replaced in a controlled way,
- and can be reviewed, restricted, withdrawn, or enforced when needed.

This Policy is an internal/professional control document and must be interpreted consistently with the POOOL Affiliate Terms & Conditions, Affiliate Code of Conduct, Qualified Referral & Payout Policy, disclosure framework, monitoring/enforcement framework, and other Program Documents. It is not itself a public-facing marketing summary. The current draft already reflects that the policy is intended as a legal-review-standard operational document rather than a website-facing text.

2. Core Rule

2.1 Affiliates may use only:

- Approved Marketing Materials,
- official POOOL public materials approved for affiliate referral use,
- and other materials expressly authorized by POOOL under this Policy.

2.2 If a material is not clearly approved, current, and valid for the intended use case, it must be treated as **not approved**.

2.3 No Affiliate may create, edit, distribute, continue using, localize, translate, combine, crop, caption, or otherwise use any material in a way that:

- changes the approved meaning,
- changes the role boundary of the Affiliate,
- omits required disclosures,
- introduces prohibited claims,
- creates advisory, recommendation, or selling risk,
- misstates POOOL's product, fees, risks, or documentation,
- or causes the content to function as a persuasion or closing tool.

2.4 A material is not compliant merely because it is visually polished, factually partial, or similar to official content. Substance controls over appearance and format.

3. Relationship to the Phase 1 Model

3.1 This Policy must always be interpreted consistently with the Phase 1 master rule:

Affiliates may introduce POOOL through general information, Approved Materials, their personal referral link, and official POOOL sources only. They may not advise, recommend, sell, negotiate, close, privately cold-outreach, or handle payments.

3.2 Even where a material has been approved in form, it must not be used in a way that turns the Affiliate's role into:

- a personal adviser,
- an asset recommender,
- a closer,
- a persuader,
- or a transaction intermediary.

3.3 The content-control test is therefore not only:

“Was the material approved?”

It is also:

“Does the use of this material keep the Affiliate inside the allowed referral-only role?”

4. Definitions

For purposes of this Policy:

“Approved Marketing Materials” means only those materials expressly authorized by POOOL for affiliate use under this Policy.

“Approved Channels” means the specific channels, placements, formats, or use cases for which a material is approved.

“Content Owner” means the internal POOOL function responsible for maintaining, updating, or governing a material.

“High-Risk Material” means a material that requires elevated review because it includes long-form explanation, more detailed product language, translated/localized content, campaign-specific conversion language, disclosure complexity, or other factors that increase legal, compliance, or misrepresentation risk.

“Localization Variant” means a translated, adapted, or region-specific version of an otherwise approved material.

“Material Registry” means the central internal record of materials, versions, owners, status, permitted uses, approval history, and withdrawal history.

“Withdrawn Material” means any material that may no longer be used, whether because it was replaced, revoked, archived from live use, or otherwise restricted by POOOL.

5. Scope

This Policy applies to all affiliate-facing or affiliate-used communication assets, including:

- public posts,
- captions,
- reels,
- stories,
- videos,
- blogs,

- landing-page copy,
- banners,
- brand visuals,
- templates,
- downloadable documents,
- PDFs,
- FAQs,
- profile or bio wording,
- referral CTA text,
- scripts,
- screenshots,
- graphics,
- campaign headlines,
- redirect wording,
- translations,
- localized adaptations,
- and any other content used to support or route referral activity.

It also applies to:

- materials stored in private folders,
- materials shared informally between Affiliates,
- agency-created or freelancer-created materials,
- and any modified derivative of an official or previously approved asset.

6. What Counts as Approved Marketing Materials

Materials count as Approved Marketing Materials only if they fall into one of the following categories and are validly approved for the intended use:

6.1 Centrally Issued Materials

Materials created and distributed by POOOL through official affiliate, compliance, marketing, product, or operations channels for approved Program use.

6.2 Official POOOL Public Materials

Official POOOL website pages, official platform pages, official help-center pages, official disclosure pages, official fee pages, official risk pages, and official public documents, to the extent POOOL permits Affiliates to link to, repost, or reference them.

6.3 Individually Approved Materials

Materials specifically submitted, reviewed, and approved through the submission-and-approval workflow under this Policy.

No material should be treated as approved merely because:

- it resembles official materials,
- another Affiliate used it,
- it was used in the past,
- no one objected to it,
- or someone gave informal verbal feedback about it.

7. Permitted Material Categories

Subject to the Terms, Code of Conduct, disclosure rules, and this Policy, Affiliates may use only the following categories of materials where properly approved:

7.1 Brand and General Awareness Materials

Examples:

- general introduction posts,
- basic “what is POOOL” content,
- approved awareness visuals,
- official campaign graphics.

7.2 Referral-Path Materials

Examples:

- approved referral landing pages,
- approved “learn more” CTA text,
- approved profile/bio wording,
- approved story swipe-up wording,
- approved referral captions.

7.3 General-Information and Official-Source Materials

Examples:

- official high-level platform descriptions,

- approved wording explaining where users can find official pages,
- approved explanations that direct users to official risk, fee, or product pages without improvising advice.

7.4 Disclosure Support Materials

Examples:

- referrer-compensation disclosure lines,
- role-limitation wording,
- “official materials govern” wording,
- other disclosure-support lines approved by POOOL.

7.5 Visual Assets

Examples:

- logos,
- brand graphics,
- image packs,
- approved screenshots,
- campaign banners,
- approved post/story templates.

7.6 Long-Form Materials

Examples:

- approved blog templates,
- approved long-form FAQ modules,
- approved explainer decks,
- approved affiliate landing-page modules.

Long-form materials should be treated as High-Risk Materials and require explicit approval before use.

8. Prohibited Materials

Affiliates must not use any material that is:

- unapproved,
- outdated after withdrawal or replacement,

- materially incomplete,
- misleadingly cropped,
- advisory in tone,
- sales-driven in tone,
- inconsistent with official POOOL information,
- missing required disclosures,
- or likely to cause confusion about the Affiliate's role.

This includes, without limitation:

- self-created pitch decks,
- custom return sheets,
- “best asset” comparison pages,
- private offer documents,
- unofficial FAQs,
- edited screenshots implying performance or certainty,
- modified fee or risk explanations,
- unofficial translations,
- improvised persuasion scripts,
- and custom content designed to reassure, push, or close a user. The current draft already identifies these risk categories clearly.

9. Channel-Use Conditions

9.1 Approval of a material does not automatically mean approval for every channel, audience, or format.

9.2 Each material may be restricted by:

- channel,
- placement,
- format,
- audience type,
- campaign,
- jurisdiction,
- disclosure requirement,
- expiry period,
- or reviewer condition.

9.3 Affiliates may use a material only:

- in the channels for which it is approved,

- in the formats for which it is approved,
- with the required disclosures,
- and in a way consistent with the approved role boundary.

9.4 A material approved for one context must not be repurposed into another context unless that repurposing is also approved.

10. Material Registry and Version Control

10.1 POOOL must maintain a central Material Registry for approved affiliate-facing content.

10.2 At minimum, each controlled material should have:

- material title,
- unique material ID,
- version number,
- issue date,
- approval date,
- Content Owner,
- approval authority,
- status,
- Approved Channels,
- required disclosure flags,
- usage conditions,
- replacement/withdrawal history,
- and archive status.

10.3 Recommended status labels:

- Draft
- Under Review
- Approved
- Approved with Conditions
- Replaced
- Withdrawn
- Archived
- Prohibited

10.4 Affiliates may use only materials marked:

- Approved, or

- Approved with Conditions,
and only within the permitted conditions.

10.5 Materials marked Replaced, Withdrawn, Archived, or Prohibited must not be used unless POOOL expressly states otherwise in writing.

10.6 Where a new approved version exists, Affiliates must use the newest approved version unless POOOL expressly allows multiple valid versions.

11. Submission and Approval Workflow

11.1 If an Affiliate, internal team, contractor, or manager wants to use a new material not already approved, that material must be submitted for review before use.

11.2 A submission should include at minimum:

- draft file or asset,
- proposed title,
- intended channels,
- intended audience/use case,
- proposed copy/caption,
- intended disclosure placement,
- translation/localization detail if relevant,
- and the reason for use.

11.3 The reviewer must assess whether the material:

- stays within the referral-only model,
- uses accurate and consistent language,
- avoids advice/recommendation/guarantee risk,
- uses the required disclosures,
- matches official POOOL information,
- is suitable for the proposed channel,
- and is consistent with the Terms and Code of Conduct.

11.4 POOOL should maintain an approval-authority matrix covering:

- standard low-risk materials,
- elevated-review materials,
- long-form materials,
- translated/localized materials,
- disclosure-heavy materials,

- and urgent takedown authority.

11.5 Informal chat approval, silence, non-response, casual review comments, or prior tolerated use must not be treated as approval.

12. Translation, Localization, and Third-Party Creation

12.1 No translation or localization variant may be used unless it has been specifically approved or issued from an approved template.

12.2 Affiliates must not translate, rewrite, adapt, or localize materials in a way that changes substance, tone, role boundary, disclosure meaning, or risk presentation.

12.3 Affiliates must not use freelancers, agencies, assistants, proxies, or third-party creators to generate affiliate-facing content unless the resulting materials go through the same approval workflow.

12.4 Third-party production support does not reduce the Affiliate's responsibility under this Policy.

13. Prohibited Modifications

Affiliates must not modify Approved Marketing Materials in a way that changes:

- meaning,
- legal/compliance profile,
- disclosure integrity,
- role limitation,
- channel suitability,
- or risk presentation.

Prohibited modifications include:

- adding return language,
- adding safety language,
- adding “guaranteed” or certainty language,
- adding asset recommendations,
- removing or hiding disclosures,
- visually minimizing mandatory text,
- cropping out contextual fee/risk information,
- changing screenshots to imply endorsement or performance,
- adding urgency or scarcity language,

- adding side-deal language,
- converting official content into personal recommendation format,
- or translating/rephrasing content so that it becomes more persuasive. The draft already captures these modification risks well and should preserve them.

14. Limited Permitted Edits

POOOL may expressly permit narrow technical edits, such as:

- resizing for format,
- changing aspect ratio,
- shortening non-substantive layout text,
- inserting the Affiliate's approved referral link where allowed,
- or using an approved language template.

Unless such edits are expressly allowed, Affiliates must assume the material must be used exactly as issued.

15. Disclosure Integrity

15.1 Where a material requires:

- referral-compensation disclosure,
- role-limitation wording,
- "official materials govern" wording,
- or other mandatory text,
the Affiliate must use that wording exactly as required or through an approved equivalent version.

15.2 Required disclosures must not be:

- removed,
- contradicted,
- hidden,
- materially softened,
- visually buried in a misleading way,
- or separated from the material in a way that changes meaning.

15.3 A material is non-compliant if its use defeats the intended disclosure logic even where the core text itself was once approved.

16. Withdrawal, Restriction, and Replacement

16.1 POOOL may withdraw, replace, suspend, restrict, or archive any material at any time.

16.2 Once a material is withdrawn or replaced, the Affiliate must promptly stop using it.

16.3 POOOL may require:

- immediate cease-use,
- immediate takedown,
- replacement by a new version,
- deletion of downloadable files,
- removal of posts,
- removal of captions,
- and other remediation actions where reasonably necessary.

16.4 An Affiliate must not assume grandfathered permission merely because a material was once approved.

16.5 Where practical, POOOL should provide:

- a replacement version,
- an update notice,
- and instructions on what must change.

17. Outdated Materials

A material should be treated as outdated where:

- a newer approved version exists,
- the underlying official information has changed,
- the Program rules have changed,
- the disclosure logic has changed,
- the brand language has changed in a compliance-relevant way,
- or POOOL has marked the material as outdated.

Outdated materials must not be used where their continued use risks inconsistency, omission, confusion, or improper persuasion.

18. Compliant and Non-Compliant Use Examples

POOOL may maintain practical examples of compliant and non-compliant use for training and moderation purposes.

Examples may include:

- compliant general-awareness posts,
- compliant referral-story examples,
- compliant profile-bio examples,
- non-compliant custom decks,
- non-compliant edited screenshots,
- non-compliant urgency captions,
- and non-compliant translation drift examples.

These examples are interpretive aids only and do not limit the broader rules of this Policy. The current draft's examples are useful and should be retained in the operating pack, whether inside this Policy or in a linked appendix.

19. Monitoring, Evidence, and Cooperation

19.1 Use of marketing materials under the Program is subject to monitoring, review, investigation, takedown, restriction, suspension, payout hold, and related enforcement controls.

19.2 Affiliates must provide, on request and within a reasonable timeframe:

- links,
- screenshots,
- files,
- captions,
- timestamps,
- publication context,
- and other evidence relevant to reviewing material use.

19.3 Failure to cooperate with a material-use review may itself be treated as a policy issue.

19.4 POOOL should retain records showing:

- what materials were approved,
- who approved them,
- what version was active,
- what channels they were approved for,

- whether disclosures were required,
- and when they were replaced, withdrawn, or archived.

20. Enforcement

20.1 If an Affiliate:

- uses unapproved materials,
 - uses outdated or withdrawn materials,
 - modifies Approved Materials improperly,
 - removes or weakens required disclosures,
 - uses approved materials in a prohibited way,
 - or otherwise breaches this Policy,
- POOOL may take immediate action where reasonably necessary.

20.2 Possible actions include:

- warning,
- correction request,
- takedown order,
- cease-use instruction,
- material access restriction,
- campaign restriction,
- link deactivation,
- referral freeze,
- payout hold,
- denial of affected commissions,
- clawback,
- suspension,
- or removal from the Program.

20.3 Interim controls may be used while facts are under review.

21. Governance and Hierarchy

21.1 This Policy must be applied together with:

- the Affiliate Terms & Conditions,
- the Affiliate Code of Conduct,
- the disclosure framework,
- the Qualified Referral & Payout Policy,

- and the monitoring/suspension/clawback framework.

21.2 This Policy governs content approval, content use, versioning, withdrawal, and material-control mechanics.

21.3 It does not by itself determine:

- final referral qualification,
- payout entitlement,
- tax status,
- privacy-law analysis,
- or final customer disclosure placement rules beyond content-integrity requirements.

21.4 Summary pages, website snippets, onboarding text, dashboard notices, and similar implementation materials do not amend this Policy unless POOOL expressly states otherwise in writing.

21.5 If there is doubt whether a material is permitted, the default rule is:

Do not use it until it is approved.

D. Final legal-review flags only

1. Final approval-authority matrix for standard, elevated, and legally sensitive material categories.
2. Whether all long-form, translated, or localized materials should require mandatory elevated review.
3. Whether certain screenshots, analytics views, product visuals, or projected-value visuals should be prohibited entirely from Affiliate use.
4. Whether urgent takedown, cease-use, and retroactive removal rights should be mirrored more explicitly in the Terms.
5. Whether material-use logs should be mandatory for all Affiliates or only for selected campaigns or higher-risk cohorts.
6. Whether reposting official POOOL content without modification should always be allowed or only allowed by category.
7. Whether third-party creator restrictions need to be mirrored in the Code of Conduct or Terms.
8. Whether response deadlines for evidence/cooperation requests should be fixed by policy or left operational.
9. Final translation/localization approval language and whether certification or reviewer sign-off is required for certain languages.

10. Any launch-specific legal requirement to embed mandatory wording directly into certain material classes.

E. Readiness note for internal review, operational use, and legal review

This draft is ready for:

- internal review,
- operational use as the core content-governance policy,
- affiliate library and moderation design,
- product/admin workflow design,
- and focused legal review.

The main improvement is that it now reads as a **true standalone materials-control policy** rather than a hybrid file combining policy, website copy, UI text, and implementation extras. It remains consistent with the baseline's core rule that Affiliates may use only approved materials, their personal referral path, and official POOOL sources within a referral-only, non-advisory, non-sales model.